



TOWN OF HARRIETSTOWN
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To: Review Committee

Date: September 19, 2025

Re: Support for Village of Saranac Lake Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

On behalf of the Town of Harrietstown, I am writing to express our strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant application to fund contractual services for accessibility upgrades at the Lake Colby Beach House.

Lake Colby Beach is located within the Town of Harrietstown and serves as one of our most popular summer recreation sites. Each year, countless Harrietstown residents, children, families, seniors, and individuals with disabilities rely on this facility as a place to gather, swim, and enjoy the outdoors. Unfortunately, the current lack of ADA-compliant bathrooms, pathways, and lifeguard facilities limits safe and equitable access for many of our residents.

Through this grant, the Village will be able to contract the professional services needed to design and implement these accessibility upgrades to modern standards. Engaging qualified engineers, architects, and construction specialists is essential to ensure that the improvements are done correctly, sustainably, and in compliance with ADA requirements.

For the Town of Harrietstown, this project represents more than physical improvements to a building, it represents an investment in our residents' quality of life, equitable access to recreation, and the long-term vitality of a cherished community resource. By making Lake Colby Beach fully inclusive, we are ensuring that all Harrietstown residents can enjoy this public space for generations to come.

The Town of Harrietstown is proud to support this application and respectfully urges your strongest consideration.

Sincerely,

Jordanna Mallach
Town Supervisor
Town of Harrietstown



September 22, 2025

RE: Support for Village of Saranac Lake Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

On behalf of the Saranac Lake Central School District, I am pleased to express our strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant application to fund contractual services for the Lake Colby Beach House accessibility upgrades.

Lake Colby Beach is an invaluable community resource for our students and their families. Each summer, youth from across our district rely on the beach for recreation, swimming lessons, and outdoor activities that build lifelong skills and confidence. However, the existing facilities create barriers for children and families with mobility challenges, preventing them from fully and safely using this public space.

Although we live in a region blessed with many lakes and rivers, the rugged terrain makes most of these places inaccessible for anyone with even moderate mobility issues. Lake Colby Beach is the only publicly accessible beach within walking distance of our Village. Yet, as it currently stands, it is not fully inclusive, leaving some of our neighbors, friends, and students unable to participate in one of the central recreational and social activities of our area.

With this grant, the Village will be able to contract professional services, including engineering, architectural, and construction expertise, to design and deliver ADA-compliant bathrooms, safe pathways, and lifeguard facilities. These improvements will ensure that Lake Colby Beach is not only more inclusive for children with disabilities, but also safer and better equipped to serve the hundreds of local students who enjoy it each year.

Investing in the accessibility of Lake Colby Beach is an investment in equity, wellness, and the quality of life within the community. We strongly urge your support of this proposal.

Sincerely,

Diane Fox
Superintendent of Schools





Village of Saranac Lake

39 Main Street, 2nd Floor Suite 9

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Dear Review Committee,

As Mayor of the Village of Saranac Lake, I am writing to express strong support for our application to the Smart Growth Grant program to secure funding for contractual services related to upgrades at the Lake Colby Beach.

Lake Colby Beach is a vital community resource where residents and visitors come together to enjoy recreation and the natural beauty of the Adirondacks. However, the existing facilities do not meet current accessibility standards, limiting the ability of many individuals to use the space safely and comfortably.

This grant funding will allow the Village to engage the professional services necessary to design, engineer, and implement ADA-compliant upgrades, including accessible bathrooms, lifeguard facilities, and safe pathways. The expertise of contracted professionals is essential to ensure the project meets regulatory requirements and provides long-term, sustainable improvements.

These upgrades will not only enhance accessibility and equity but also support the Smart Growth principles of sustainable community development, improved quality of life, and economic vitality through inclusive recreation.

On behalf of the Village of Saranac Lake, I respectfully urge your strong consideration of this application. With your support, we can ensure that Lake Colby Beach is a safe, welcoming, and inclusive destination for generations to come.

Sincerely,

Jimmy Williams

Mayor, Village of Saranac Lake



Franklin County
Office of Economic Development & Tourism
355 W. Main Street
Malone, New York 12953

September 17, 2025

Re: Support for Village of Saranac Lake Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

I am writing to express strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant application to fund contractual services for the Lake Colby Beach House accessibility upgrades.

Lake Colby Beach is not only a treasured space for the Village of Saranac Lake, but also for families and visitors from across Franklin County. Each summer, the beach serves as a regional hub for recreation, drawing people from throughout the county to swim, gather, and enjoy the outdoors. Unfortunately, the current facilities limit access for individuals with mobility challenges, preventing full use of this public asset.

This grant funding will allow the Village to contract professional services, architectural, engineering, and construction expertise, to design and implement ADA-compliant bathrooms, lifeguard facilities, and accessible pathways. These improvements will ensure that Lake Colby Beach becomes a fully inclusive and safe destination, benefitting not only local residents but also strengthening Franklin County's appeal as a welcoming place to live, work, and visit.

By investing in accessibility at Lake Colby Beach, this project advances Smart Growth principles while improving regional quality of life, promoting equitable access, and supporting sustainable tourism across Franklin County.

I strongly encourage your favorable consideration of this application.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Phil Hans".

Phil Hans
Economic Development & Tourism Director
Franklin County

Re: Support for the Village of Saranac Lake – Contractual Services towards Design of Lake Colby Beach Upgrades

Dear Review Committee,

On behalf of the Saranac Lake Parks & Trails Advisory Board, we strongly support the Village's application for Smart Growth Grant funding to provide contractual services for accessibility upgrades at the Lake Colby Beach House.

The Board's mission is to promote safe, inclusive, and sustainable use of Village parks and trails. Lake Colby Beach is a key community resource, and ADA-compliant improvements will ensure everyone can safely enjoy this space. Engaging professional services is essential to plan and implement these upgrades correctly and sustainably.

This project directly advances our goals by improving accessibility, enhancing public safety, and supporting inclusive recreation. We strongly encourage your consideration of this application.

Sincerely,



Colleen O'Neill
Chair, Saranac Lake Parks & Trails Advisory Board